

The World Beneath

Kickstarter funding plan, pitch structure, reward tiers, and stretch goals

Prepared as a practical Phase One launch package

My mission is to build The World Beneath as a video game first, then open it into a living IP where creators and fans can gather, create, sell, play, and grow the world together through story.

- This starts as my game, my company, and my seed framework.
- The long-term point is not to lock the universe inside one studio forever.
- The Creator Kit, canon archive, and AI coordinator let the community build without breaking the world.
- If the world grows beyond me, that means it worked.

What The World Beneath Is

The World Beneath is the world under the world.

- Modern reality with the hidden layer made true.
- Magic is real. Aliens are real. Secret organizations are real.
- Fairy tales are buried history. Intent has power. Filth can manifest.
- The framework supports modern stories, period pieces, trench warfare, comics, books, mobile games, visual novels, 3D prints, and more.

What Launches Before Kickstarter

Garden web app

Released free before launch. It proves the world can be played and gives backers something real to touch.

Book and audiobook

Proof that the world has story depth outside the game.

Trenchworks

The first paid game/code reward. A World War I trench warfare game with The World Beneath twist.

Creator framework

Creator Kit outline, canon archive structure, and AI coordinator plan ready to show.

The Kickstarter Should Fund Phase One

Do not pitch an unlimited forever-IP. Pitch the seed that makes the world possible.

- Trenchworks delivery as the first paid game/code reward.
- Creator Kit v1 for people who want to build under the IP.
- Living Canon Archive v1 as the memory of the world.
- AI Canon Coordinator prototype for idea checks and creator suggestions.
- Community hub, legal setup, and one year of founder runway.

Recommended Kickstarter Ask: \$150,000

\$150,000

Public base goal for Phase One

Enough to fund runway, tools, legal setup, and delivery.

Gross-to-working-budget model

\$150,000	Gross Kickstarter goal
-\$15,000	Platform/payment/pledge-loss reserve
-\$30,000	Tax/CPA reserve
\$105,000	Approximate working budget

Working budget allocation

12-month founder runway	\$36,000
Emergency/equipment/side operating reserve	\$30,000
AI/cloud/tools/community stack	\$12,000
Legal/IP/creator-license setup	\$10,000
Contractor/art/audio/code reserve	\$6,000
Campaign/community marketing	\$3,000
Admin/accounting/distribution setup	\$3,000
Working buffer	\$5,000

Treat this as planning math, not tax advice. A CPA should confirm the final tax treatment before launch.

Why \$150,000 Is The Right Ask

- \$100,000 is probably too low after fees, tax reserve, legal setup, AI/cloud costs, and survival runway.
- \$200,000 is better as a stretch goal level unless the pre-launch audience is already very strong.
- \$150,000 gives a real working budget while still being explainable as a focused Phase One.
- The public ask should be ambitious, but the base promise must stay shippable.

Core Reward Tiers

Tier	Name	Reward
\$5	Signal Backer	Founding Archive name, updates, community role.
\$15	Lore Backer	Digital lore primer, wallpapers/key art, archive name.
\$25	Story Backer	Digital book + audiobook + lore pack.
\$35	Trenchworks Backer	Trenchworks digital code. Steam if ready; fallback delivery if not.
\$60	Founder Bundle	Trenchworks + book + audiobook + lore pack + Founder credit.
\$100	Creator Kit Early Access	Creator Kit, canon archive preview, AI coordinator test access.

Keep the main reward stack simple. Premium creator tiers can be limited quantities below the main stack.

Premium Creator Tiers

Tier	Name	Reward
\$250	Canon Fit Workshop	Submit one project idea for a structured canon-fit report.
\$500	Founding Creator Circle	Private creator roundtables and deeper feedback. Limited quantity.
\$1,000	Canon Circle Consultation	One private project-planning session. Limited quantity.
\$5,000	Lifetime Creator Pass	Lifetime creator tools access, archive access, AI access with fair-use limits, priority listing. No equity, no guaranteed canon approval.

The \$5,000 tier must be worded as access to creator tools and founder recognition, not ownership, equity, or guaranteed profit.

Stretch Goal Ladder

Funding	Unlock	What It Adds
\$150k	Base goal	Phase One funded: Trenchworks, Creator Kit, archive, AI coordinator, community launch.
\$175k	Alchemy Key	Small crafting/recipe web minigame built around intent and corruption risk.
\$200k	Mining Key + Book 2	First major expansion: resource minigame plus next digital book/novella.
\$225k	Timber and Foraging Key	Cursed groves, old-growth materials, herbs, fungi, and natural occult resources.
\$250k	Enchanting Key	Intent-binding and object-charging minigame.
\$275k	Salvage and Relics Key	Battlefields, ruins, wrecks, relic fragments, and lore discovery.
\$300k	Book 2 Audio + Bestiary	Audiobook upgrade plus creature-identification World Key.

World Keys should stay small, digital, and connected to lore. Do not turn stretch goals into giant new games.

The archive is the memory of the world.

- Tracks canon rules, factions, eras, events, creatures, artifacts, magic systems, filth phenomena, and creator project status.
- Lets many people create without stepping on each other constantly.
- Keeps the world coherent while still leaving creators room to build.
- Without the archive, scale becomes chaos. With the archive, scale becomes a strength.

The AI coordinator is a lore assistant, not a dictator.

- Checks project ideas against the canon archive.
- Flags conflicts and suggests fixes.
- Connects ideas to factions, eras, creatures, rules, and locations.
- Sorts projects into fan project, creator project, canon candidate, official canon, or non-canon but allowed.
- Helps creators move faster without breaking the world.

Creators need people to create for. Fans need a world worth gathering around.

- The game brings fans in.
- The community gives people a place to gather.
- The Creator Kit lets creators build inside the world.
- More creator content gives fans more reasons to stay.
- More fans give creators more reason to build.
- Community through story is the center.

Legal and Delivery Guardrails

- Do not promise unlimited IP freedom. Use a creator license, canon guidelines, approved assets, and review rules.
- Do not offer equity, financial returns, loans, or profit share on Kickstarter.
- Disclose AI use clearly: tools, role, AI-produced elements, source data, consent/credit handling.
- Avoid physical rewards in the first campaign unless fulfillment is already solved.
- Use Steam as intended delivery for Trenchworks, but keep [itch.io/direct](https://itch.io/) download as fallback.

I am not asking you to just back a game. I am asking you to help seed a world.

- The Garden web app proves the world before launch.
- Trenchworks gives backers the first paid game/code reward.
- The Creator Kit opens the door for creators.
- The canon archive and AI coordinator keep the world organized.
- The community is the point.

Sources Checked

- Kickstarter fees: 5% platform fee plus Stripe payment processing roughly 3-5% on successful projects.
- Kickstarter AI rules: disclose AI tools, AI-produced elements, original work, data sources, consent, and credit.
- Kickstarter rewards: keep reward tiers simple and tied to schedule/budget.
- Kickstarter stretch goals: not an official platform feature; they add complexity and fulfillment risk.
- Steam Direct: \$100 fee per product/app plus setup, review, and timing requirements.